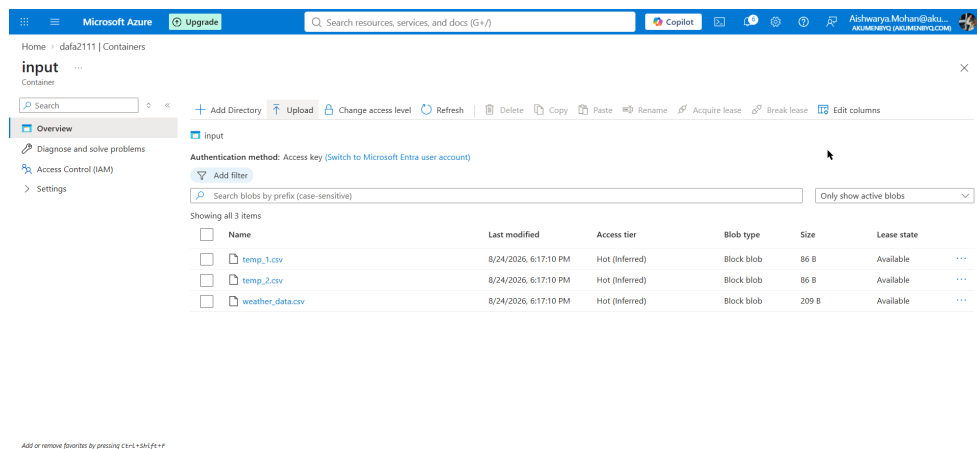
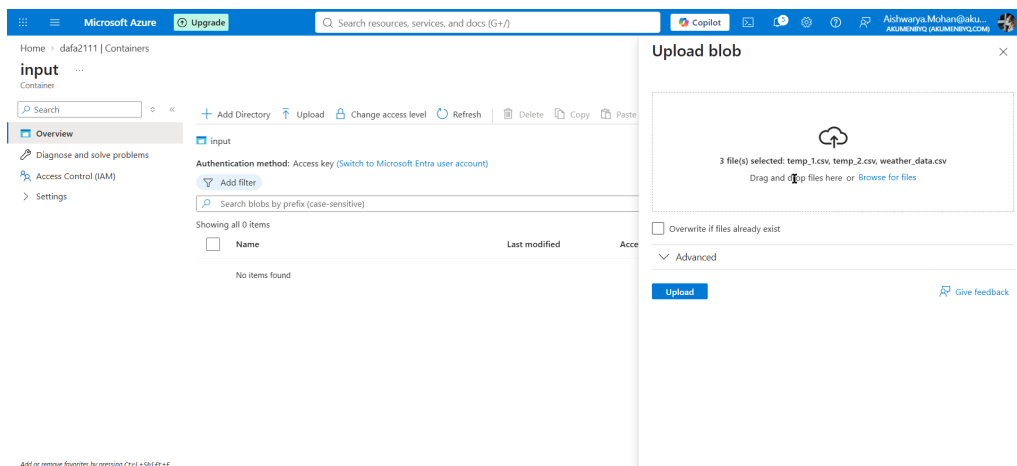
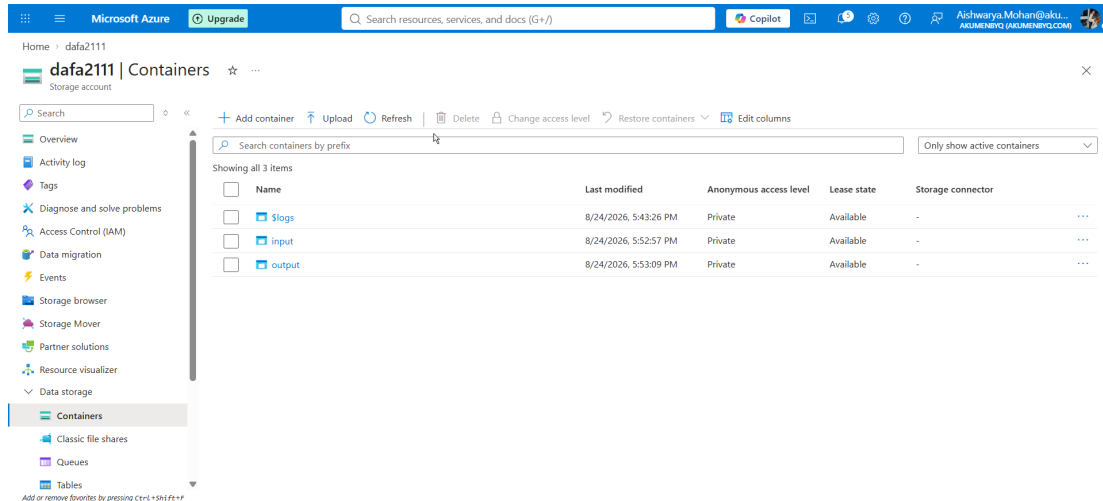


Azure Data Factory – Control Flow

Get Metadata → ForEach → If Condition

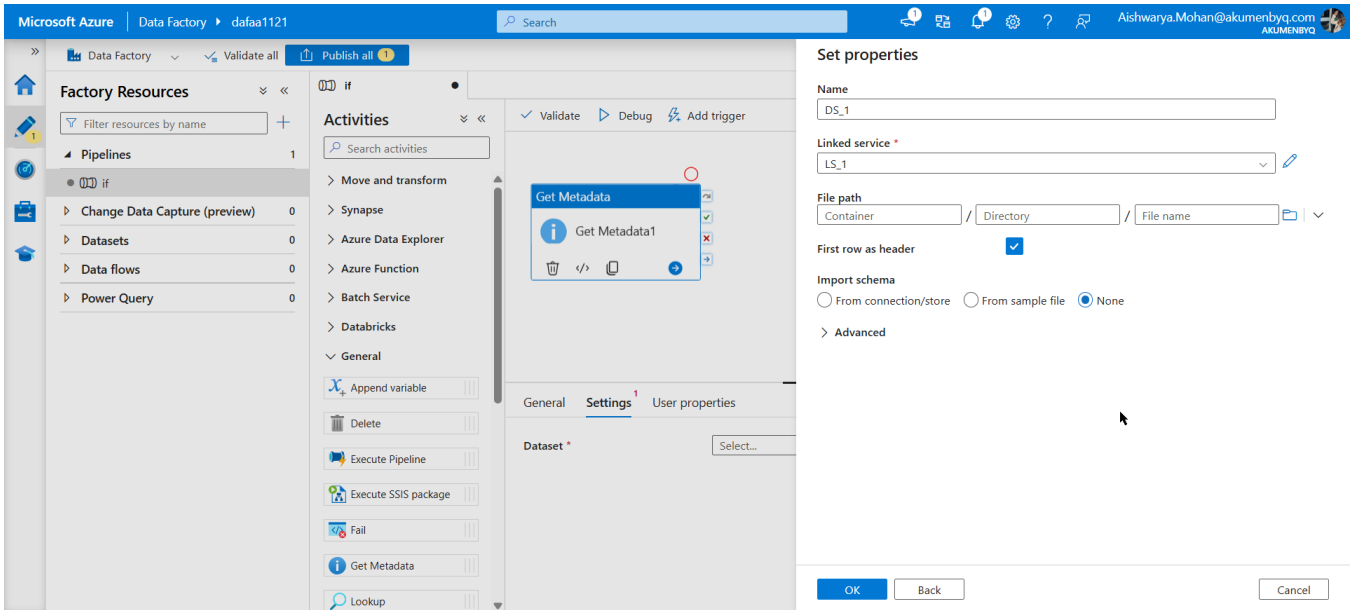
① Storage Setup

Create containers **input** & **output** → Upload 3 files to input

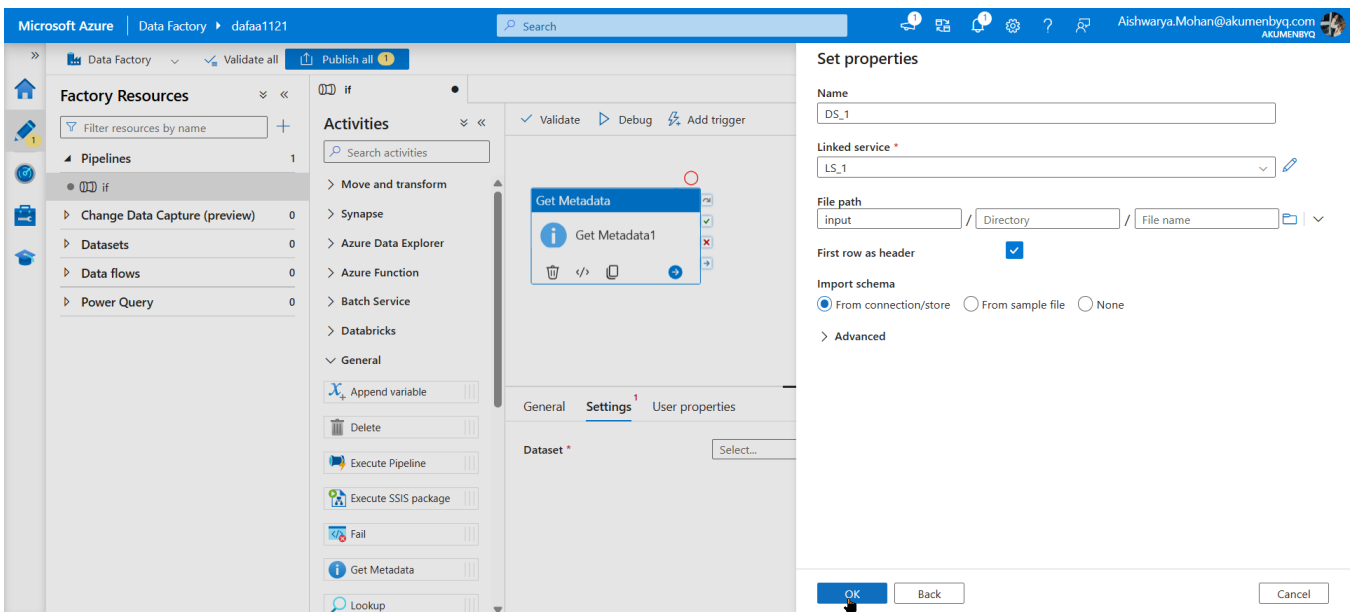


② Get Metadata Activity

Dataset DS_1 → Container = input | Field list = Child items



Create dataset DS_1 linked to input container



File path set to input | Import schema = From connection/store

③ ForEach + If Condition

Items = @activity('Get Metadata1').output.childItems
Expression = @contains(item().name,'temp')

The screenshot shows the 'Get Metadata' activity configuration in the Microsoft Azure Data Factory portal. The 'Field list' is set to 'Child items'. The 'Dataset' is 'DS_1'. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'Name' as 'if'.

Get Metadata1 connected → Field list = Child items

The screenshot shows the pipeline editor with a 'Get Metadata' activity connected to a 'ForEach' activity. The 'ForEach' activity is named 'ForEach1' and contains a sub-activity named 'Activities'. The 'Settings' pane for 'ForEach1' shows 'Concurrency' set to 1 and 'Elapsed time metric' set to '0.00:10:00'.

ForEach1 added after Get Metadata1

④ ForEach Settings + Expression

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' with a count of 1. The main canvas displays a pipeline with a 'Get Metadata' activity followed by a 'ForEach' activity. The 'ForEach' activity is selected, and its 'Settings' tab is active. The 'Items' property is highlighted with a red box, and an error message states: 'This property should be parameterized.' The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with fields for Name, Description, and Annotations.

Items property must be parameterized

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface with the 'Pipeline expression builder' dialog open. The dialog contains a text area with the expression `@activity('Get Metadata1').output.childItems`. Below the text area, the 'Activity outputs' tab is selected, showing a list of outputs including 'Get Metadata1 childItems'. The 'OK' button is highlighted.

Expression builder → select childItems

⑤ Add If Condition inside ForEach

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' with a count of 1. The main canvas displays a pipeline with a 'Get Metadata' activity followed by a 'ForEach' activity named 'ForEach1'. The 'Add trigger' dialog is open, showing the 'If' condition type. The 'Items' field is set to '@activity('Get Metadata1').output.chi...'. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with the name 'if' and a description field.

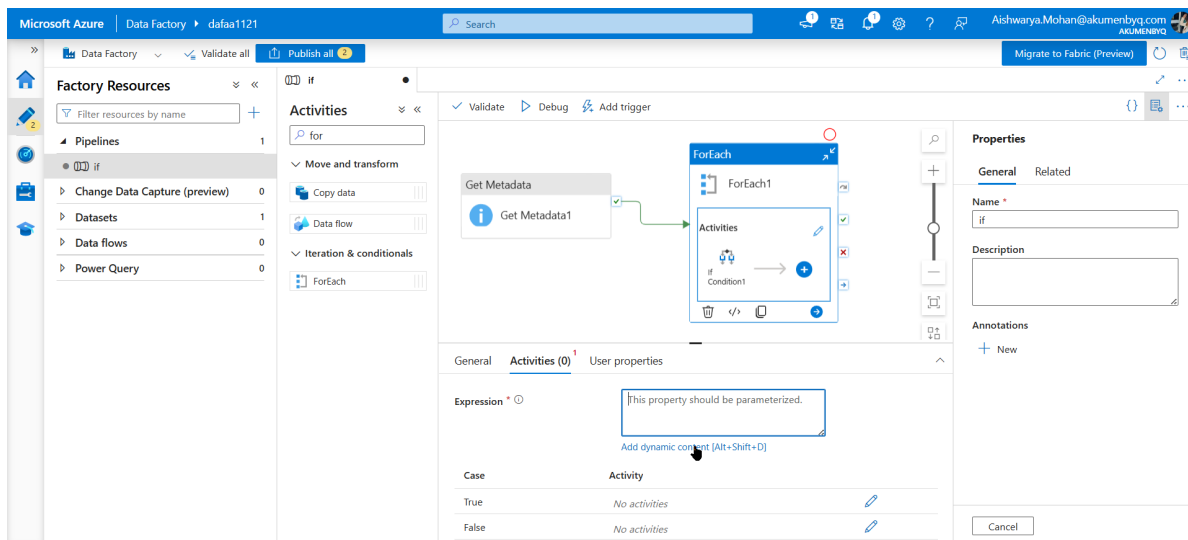
Search & drag If Condition inside ForEach activities

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. The 'If Condition' activity has been added inside the 'ForEach' activity. The 'General' tab of the 'If Condition' activity is selected, showing the name 'If Condition1' and the description field. The 'Activity state' is set to 'Activated'.

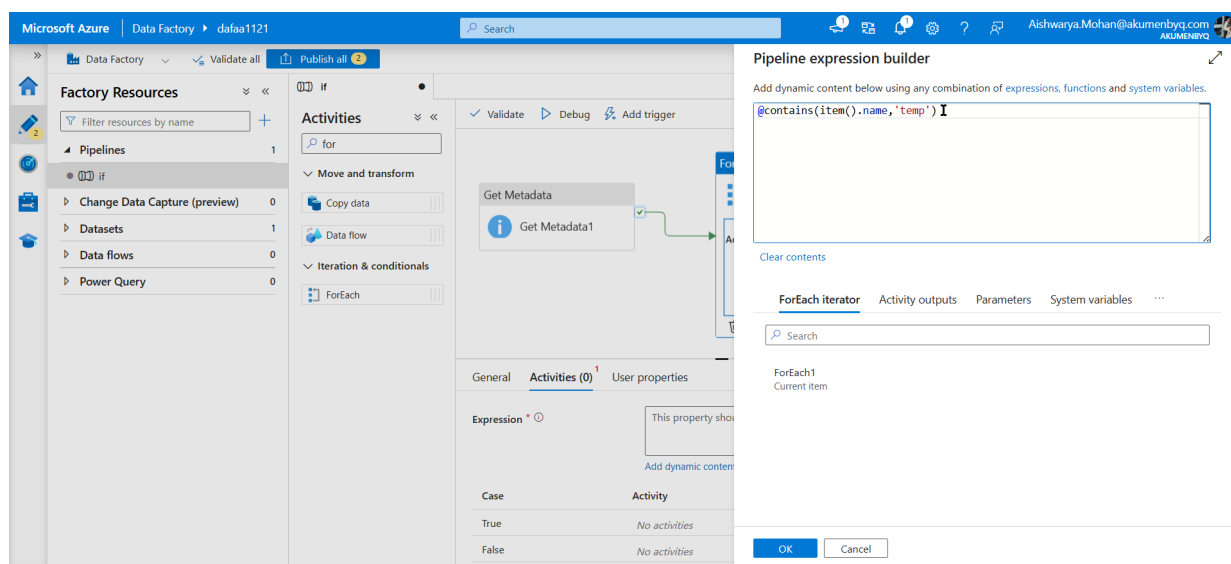
If Condition1 appears inside ForEach

⑥ True / False Branches with Set Variable

True → Set variable temp = True
False → Set variable weather = False

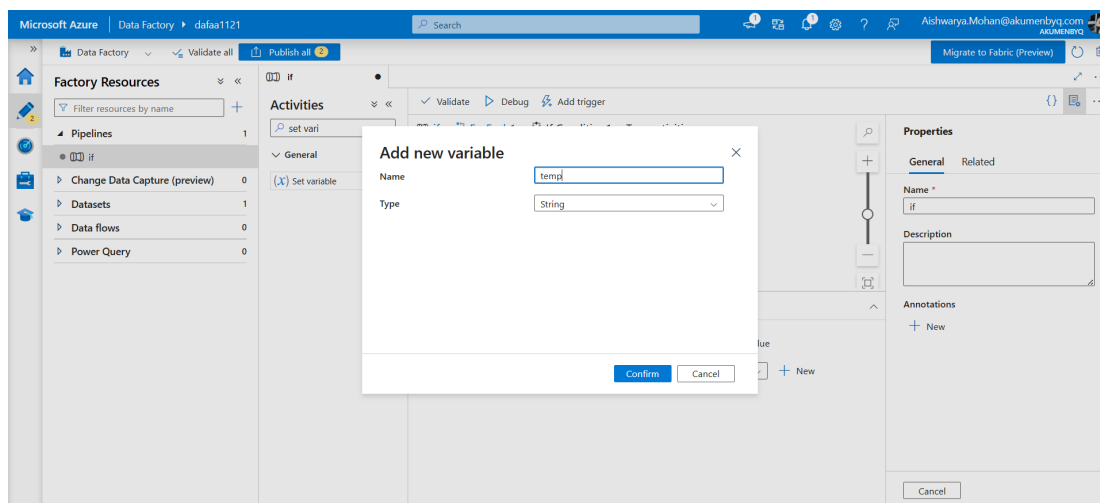


Expression property → Add dynamic content

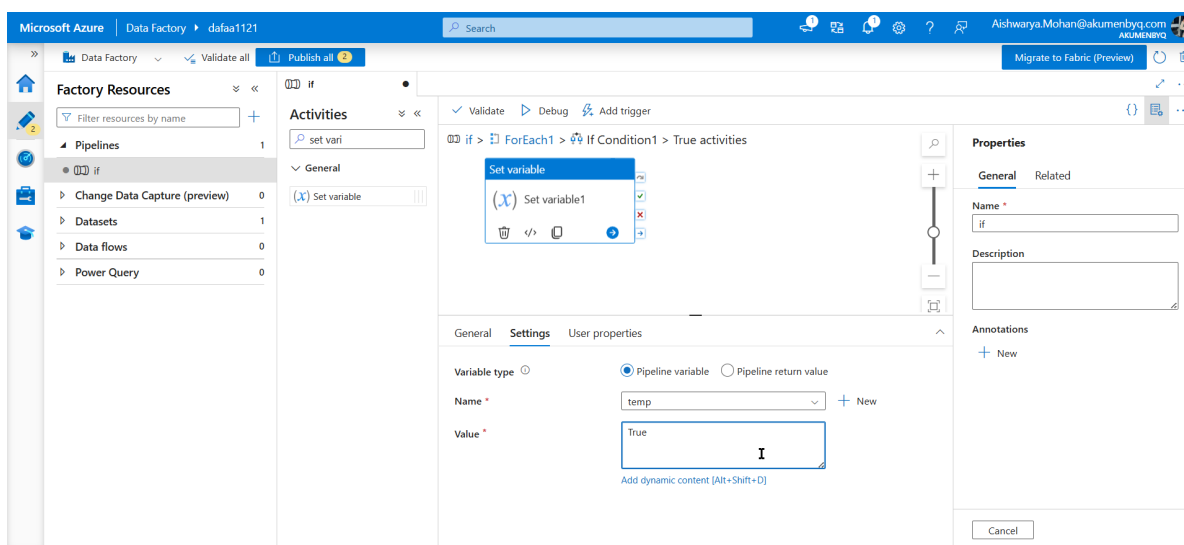


`@contains(item().name, 'temp')`

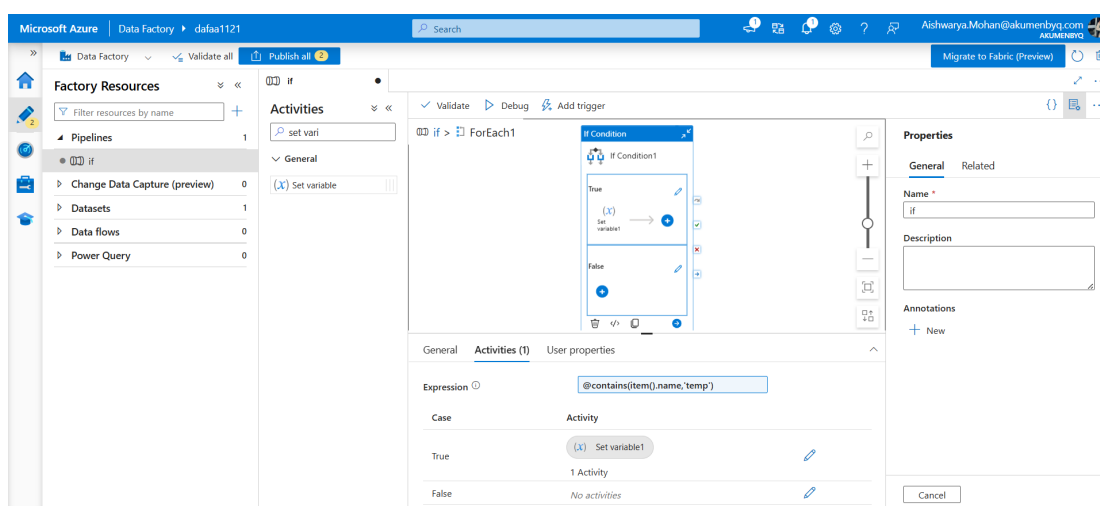
⑦ Create Variables & Set Values



Add new variable: temp (String)



True branch → Set variable1 → Value = True



If Condition shows True: Set variable1 | False: empty

⑧ False Branch Set Variable

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory editor interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' (1), 'Datasets' (1), 'Data flows' (0), and 'Power Query' (0). The 'Activities' pane shows 'Set variable'. The main canvas displays an 'If' condition with two branches: 'True' and 'False'. The 'False' branch contains a 'Set variable' activity. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with 'Name' set to 'if' and 'Description' empty. The 'Settings' tab is active, showing 'Variable type' as 'Pipeline variable', 'Name' as 'weather', and 'Value' as 'False'.

False branch → Set variable2 → weather = False

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory editor interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' (1), 'Datasets' (1), 'Data flows' (0), and 'Power Query' (0). The 'Activities' pane shows 'Set variable'. The main canvas displays an 'If' condition with two branches: 'True' and 'False'. The 'True' branch contains a 'Set variable' activity. The 'False' branch contains a 'Set variable' activity. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with 'Name' set to 'if' and 'Description' empty. The 'Settings' tab is active, showing 'Expression' as '@contains(item().name,'temp')', 'Case' as 'Activity', 'True' as 'Set variable1', and 'False' as 'Set variable2'.

Both True & False branches now have Set variable

⑨ Debug Result (Set Variable version)

All activities Succeeded

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface for a pipeline named 'if'. The pipeline is in a 'Succeeded' state, and the 'Debug' tab is active. The pipeline diagram shows a sequence of activities: 'Get Metadata' (Get Metadata1), 'Set variable' (Set variable), 'If Condition' (If Condition1), and 'ForEach' (ForEach1). The 'Output' tab is selected, showing a table of activity results.

Activity name	Activity status	Activity name	Run start	Duration
Set variable2	✓ Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
Set variable1	✓ Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
Set variable1	✓ Succeeded	Set variable	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	Les
If Condition1	✓ Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
If Condition1	✓ Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
If Condition1	✓ Succeeded	If Condition	8/24/2026, 6:49:36 PM	2s
ForEach1	✓ Succeeded	ForEach	8/24/2026, 6:49:35 PM	4s
Get Metadata1	✓ Succeeded	Get Metadata	8/24/2026, 6:49:16 PM	18s

Pipeline run output – Get Metadata, ForEach, If Condition, Set variables all green

10 Replace Set Variable with Copy Data

True → Copy data1 | False → Copy data2

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' (1), 'Datasets' (2), and 'Data flows' (0). The 'Activities' pane shows 'Copy data' selected. The main canvas displays a pipeline with an 'if' condition. The 'True' branch contains a 'Copy data' activity. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with 'Name' set to 'if' and 'Description' empty. The 'Source' tab is active, showing 'Source dataset' as 'DS_True1', 'File path type' as 'File path in dataset', and 'Recursively' checked.

Copy data1 inside True activities – Source = DS_True1

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Azure Data Factory interface. On the left, the 'Factory Resources' pane lists 'Pipelines' (1), 'Datasets' (2), and 'Data flows' (0). The 'Activities' pane shows 'Copy data' selected. The main canvas displays a pipeline with an 'if' condition. The 'True' branch contains a 'Copy data' activity. The 'Properties' pane on the right shows the 'General' tab with 'Name' set to 'if' and 'Description' empty. The 'Source' tab is active, showing 'Source dataset' as 'DS_True1', 'File path type' as 'File path in dataset', and 'Recursively' checked.

Dataset DS_True1 points to input container

Final Pipeline with Copy Activities

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines: 1
 - if
- Change Data Capture (preview): 0
- Datasets: 4
 - DS_1
 - DS_False
 - DS_False1
 - DS_True1
- Data flows: 0
- Power Query: 0

Activities

- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Synapse
- Azure Data Explorer
- Azure Function
- Batch Service
- Databricks
- General
 - Append variable
 - Delete
 - Execute Pipeline
 - Execute SSIS package
 - Fail

Properties

General

Name: if

Description:

Annotations: + New

Activity state: Validated

Pipeline validation output

Your pipeline has been validated.
No errors were found.

If Condition1 → True: Copy data1 | False: Copy data2

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines: 1
 - if
- Change Data Capture (preview): 0
- Datasets: 4
 - DS_1
 - DS_False
 - DS_False1
 - DS_True1
- Data flows: 0
- Power Query: 0

Activities

- Move and transform
 - Copy data
 - Data flow
- Synapse
- Azure Data Explorer
- Azure Function
- Batch Service
- Databricks
- General
 - Append variable
 - Delete
 - Execute Pipeline
 - Execute SSIS package
 - Fail

Properties

General

Name: if

Description:

Annotations: + New

Activity state: Validated

Pipeline validation output

Your pipeline has been validated.
No errors were found.

Pipeline validated successfully – No errors found

■ Pipeline Run & Output Container

Files copied to output container

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Factory Resources

- Pipelines
- Datasets
- Data flows
- Power Query

Activities

- Copy data
- Data flow
- Synapse
- Azure Data Explorer
- Azure Function
- Batch Service
- Databricks

Properties

General

Name: if

Description:

Annotations

+ New

Debug run – All Copy data & If Condition activities Succeeded

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output

Container

Overview

Authentication method: Access key (Switch to Microsoft Entra user account)

Search blobs by prefix (case-sensitive)

Only show active blobs

Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
Pokemon.csv	8/24/2026, 7:10:04 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	4.6 KiB	Available
temp_2.csv	8/24/2026, 7:18:41 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available

output container now contains the copied files

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input

Container

Overview

Authentication method: Access key (Switch to Microsoft Entra user account)

Search blobs by prefix (case-sensitive)

Only show active blobs

Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
Pokemon.csv	8/24/2026, 7:18:40 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	4.6 KiB	Available
temp_1.csv	8/24/2026, 6:17:10 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available
temp_2.csv	8/24/2026, 7:12:45 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	86 B	Available
weather_data.csv	8/24/2026, 6:17:10 PM	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	209 B	Available

input container still has original files + Pokemon.csv

Logic: Get Metadata → ForEach → If contains('temp') → True: Copy | False: Copy